Poetry anthology

Experience & memory

1 Nature and childhood

The Schoolboy: fear restricts natural growth. **Wordsworth:** remembered nature restores joy. **Blackberry Picking:** desired pleasure gives way to decay.

Compare who or what causes change: authority, recollection or time.

2 Home and the past

I Shall Return: homeland remembered; return hoped for. **Drummer Hodge:** burial abroad makes separation permanent.

Place can preserve identity or expose distance from it. Compare the endings, not just landscape words.

Relationships & identity

3 Love and distance

Sonnet 29: thoughts must give way to the real beloved. **Dusting the Phone:** imagined contact becomes anxious dependence.

Cousin Kate: rejection and public judgement meet maternal pride. Compare power and the speaker's final position.

4 Family and selfhood

Catrin: connection survives conflict over independence. **Origin Story:** imperfect parental love can leave a valuable legacy.

Both look back, but from different generations. A shared theme does not mean the same attitude.

Conflict & judgement

5 War beyond the battlefield

Disabled: injury and neglected homecoming. **Kamikaze:** survival followed by exclusion. **Remains:** a violent event persists in memory.

Distinguish physical loss, social punishment and psychological harm.

6 Looking and responsibility

Human suffering → Selected image

Selected image → Viewer response

War Photographer: witness, editor and audience respond differently. **Decomposition:** an observer rethinks making art from hardship.

For every poem: voice → changing ideas → language/form/structure → relevant context. Compare effects with evidence.